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April 03, 2026

U.S. Department of Homeland Security
U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services

Re: Sivashankaran Harikrishnan

To Whom It May Concern:

This letter is issued in reference to Mr. Sivashankaran Harikrishnan job duties. I have firsthand knowledge of Mr. Harikrishnan's full-time (40 hours per week) employment in a managerial role at Cognizant Technology Solutions India Pvt Ltd in India from July 2025 to September 2025. I hold the position of Senior Director at Cognizant Technology Solutions India Pvt Ltd in India and served as Mr. Harikrishnan's manager in India during the mentioned time period.

Mr. Harikrishnan offered direction and support to both onshore and offshore Cognizant team members in the design and development of customized software. His guidance ensured that all solutions met required technical standards while also prioritizing customer satisfaction. In today's fast-moving and globally connected IT landscape, Cognizant relies on a combination of local, on-the-ground teams and offshore teams to carry out critical functions, including the creation of tailored technology solutions.

In this role, Mr. Harikrishnan acted as a manager who demonstrated strong capability in organizing and overseeing the daily operations of his offshore team, which carried out critical functions. At the same time, he effectively collaborated with on-site teams working on the same project. He fostered a sense of teamwork by leading meetings to define project goals and objectives, ensuring that all team members clearly understood and adhered to the project plans.

Drawing on his extensive IT project management experience, Mr. Harikrishnan led the daily activities of both onsite and offshore team members, assigning work according to the specific phase or component of each project. He provided direction grounded in his deep knowledge of the methodologies, tools, and technologies required to successfully deliver

the projects. Leveraging his strong technical expertise and clear understanding of the underlying systems, he guided his team in producing high-quality software deliverables. Overall, Mr. Harikrishnan demonstrated effective leadership through comprehensive project management responsibilities, including tracking and reporting key metrics—such as deliverables—to senior management at Cognizant. He mentored and supervised the development team, overseeing both onsite and offshore coordination, planning and execution of customized solutions, and knowledge transfer activities, including training junior team members. Additionally, he acted as a key escalation point for resolving technical challenges, setting performance goals, and providing constructive feedback to his team.

On a daily basis, Mr. Harikrishnan's responsibilities involved establishing the structure of his assigned team and exercising authority to make recommendations regarding hiring, termination, promotions, and compensation for team members holding college or university degrees at Cognizant. He conducted interviews for prospective candidates, suggested team members for promotions or salary adjustments, and provided guidance to team leads to maintain quality and compliance with technical standards and processes.

Mr. Harikrishnan was accountable for supervising and managing the deployment of Cognizant's customized solutions. A key aspect of his managerial role was assessing resource allocation and adjusting project plans as needed by comparing actual effort against projected budgets, thereby directly affecting the financial performance of assigned projects, including revenue, profitability, and cost-effectiveness. In this role, he also addressed performance shortfalls, scheduling delays, and unexpected operational issues that could affect overall productivity and project delivery timelines.

Additionally, Mr. Harikrishnan managed the review and execution of change requests that impacted the defined project scope, ensuring that all adjustments were carefully evaluated and implemented within set timelines and budget limits to prevent disruptions to project progress. He was also responsible for overseeing quality control, using a metrics-driven approach to ensure that deliverables met project requirements, standards, and client expectations.

Furthermore, he managed costs within his area of responsibility by continuously monitoring factors such as project scope, quality standards, and team productivity. By regularly analyzing project dashboards and performance metrics, he identified gaps in documentation and workflow processes and implemented targeted improvements to reduce risks, increase efficiency, and support the timely completion of projects.

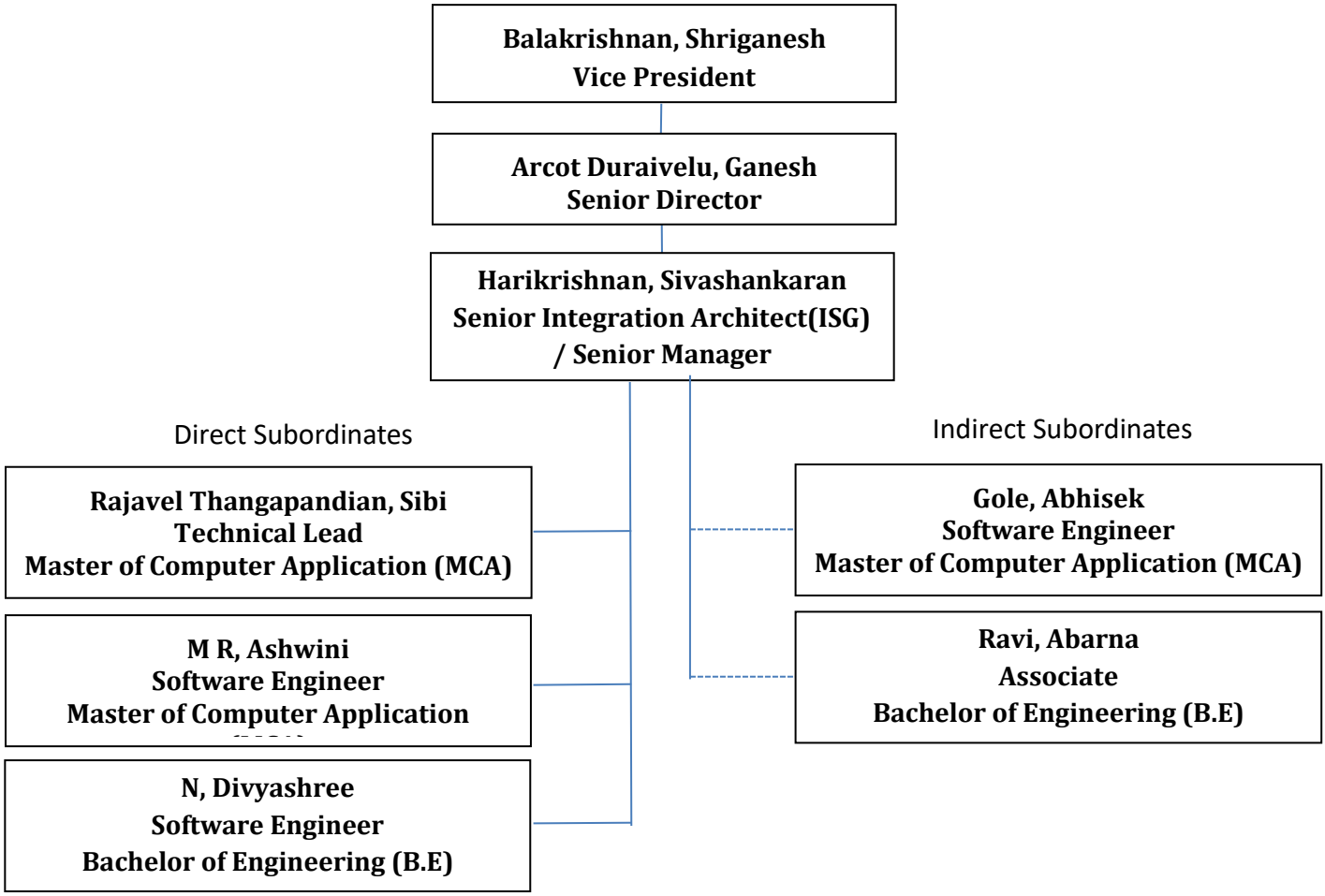
I provide the below table describing Mr. Harikrishnan's role and percentage of time:

Sivashankaran Harikrishnan Senior Manager	**Percentage of Time**
<u>People Management</u>	

• Authorized hiring and termination decisions for the Health Suite Platform business. • Established project team objectives and monitored their performance. • Recommended compensation adjustments, rewards, and promotions based on performance reviews. • Conducted interviews and recruited skilled professionals in the U.S. and internationally for active projects. • Oversaw billing, forecasting, and time tracking for the assigned portion of the project. • Managed team ramp-up and ramp-down activities in response to changing business needs. • Efficiently supervised multiple projects and team members to achieve successful outcomes. • Assigned tasks and responsibilities to team leaders to ensure project goals were met. • Maintained effective leave management while ensuring deliverables were not disrupted, through proper backup arrangements.	50%
<u>Business Management</u> • Supervised the Campaign Management, Professional Services, and Cloud Platform Services departments. • Gained extensive experience in managing multiple projects and teams simultaneously. • Held regular meetings with clients and stakeholders to provide business updates and track project progress. • Optimized resource utilization to ensure timely and successful delivery of results. • Collaborated closely with senior leadership to align the team's efforts with organizational objectives. • Participated in responding to client-issued RFPs (Requests for Proposal) and RFIs (Requests for Information). • Led, coached, mentored, and developed team members to prepare them for future leadership roles. • Coordinated with clients to address project escalations and took appropriate actions to strengthen client relationships. • Continuously identified process and control improvements to enhance overall operational efficiency. • Held responsibility for approving project budgets. • Ensured that customer commitments, satisfaction, quality standards, and performance targets were consistently achieved.	20%
<u>Delivery Management</u>	

• Developed business proposals, assigned tasks to the team for solution development, and managed resource allocation and cost planning. • Reviewed service level agreements (SLAs) and delivered performance reports to management and clients, including formal presentations. • Designed and implemented the integration and interoperability strategy across business units and R&D teams. • Engaged with clients to negotiate and align project deliverables with available opportunities.	15%
<u>Operation Management</u> • Took part in strategic program-level meetings to ensure service scope goals and objectives were met. • Coordinated and facilitated customer security questionnaires and audit processes. • Oversaw overall resource planning and assigned resources to projects based on specific project needs.	15%
TOTAL	**100%**

The below chart depicts Mr. Harikrishnan's role within the hierarchy of the assigned managerial engagement:



We provide a detailed description of each direct and in-direct subordinate. All of the below team members of Cognizant are professional employees, holding at minimum either a U.S. bachelor's degree or foreign equivalent.

Subordinates Names	**Job Title & Location**	**Detailed Job duties and Percentage of Time**	**Highest Degree**
Mr. Rajavel Thangapandian, Sibi	Technical Lead, Offshore	• He managed Professional Services for the HL7 FHIR Project. • He completed assigned tasks with the desired quality and within the stipulated time – 50%. • He worked on process improvements for daily deliverables, leading to increased productivity – 30%. • He coached and mentored team members – 20%.	Masters in Computer Application (MCA)
Ms. M R, Ashwini	Software Engineer, Offshore	• She supported Professional Services for the Mirth HIE Project. • She completed assigned tasks with the desired quality and within the stipulated time – 50%. • She worked on process improvements for daily deliverables, leading to increased productivity – 30%. • She coached and mentored team members – 20%.	Masters in Computer Application (MCA)
Ms. N, Divyashree	Software Engineer, Offshore	• She supported the OPENLink Interface projects. • She completed assigned tasks with the desired quality and within the stipulated time – 50% • She worked on process improvements for daily deliverables, leading to	Bachelor of Engineering (B.E)

		increased productivity – 30% She coached and mentored team members – 20%	
Ms. Ravi, Abarna	Associate, Offshore	• She supported the OPENLink Interface projects. • She completed assigned tasks with the desired quality and within the stipulated time – 50%. • She worked on process improvements for daily deliverables, leading to increased productivity – 30%. • She coached and mentored team members – 20%	Bachelor of Engineering (B.E)
Mr. Gole, Abhisek	Software Engineer, Offshore	• He supported the OPENLink Interface projects. • He completed assigned tasks with the desired quality and within the stipulated time – 50%. • He worked on process improvements for daily deliverables, leading to increased productivity – 30%. • He coached and mentored team members – 20%	Master of Computer Application (MCA)

Mr. Harikrishnan's managerial responsibilities remained consistent across both direct and indirect subordinates, reflecting Cognizant's business model, which combines vertical segments (industry-specific areas like banking, finance, healthcare, etc.) and horizontal segments (specialized services such as testing, system architecture, and consulting). He directed, supervised, assigned tasks, evaluated work quality, and provided guidance for career development to all team members, whether direct or indirect reports. The only distinction for indirect subordinates related to corporate performance evaluation procedures: while the direct manager submitted the official annual performance review,

Mr. Harikrishnan contributed substantial input regarding the performance of his indirect subordinates.

In summary, I affirm that Mr. Harikrishnan's role as Senior Manager was managerial in nature and essential to sustaining the ongoing success and leadership of our company.

Sincerely,

Arcot Duraivelu, Ganesh
Designation: Senior Director